



Mini motors

Front of car opens out as a single door

① Volkswagen Beetle Germany 1945



13 ft 6 in (4.1 m) long

② BMW Isetta 300 Germany 1955



7 ft 6 in (2.3 m) long

③ Messerschmitt KR200 Germany 1956



9 ft 4 in (2.8 m) long

Shallow doors open out at the front

④ Frisky Family Three UK 1958



10 ft 2 in (3.1 m) long

The Subaru 360 took **37 seconds** to do 0–60mph (0–100km/h).

⑤ Subaru 360 Japan 1958



⑥ Austin Mini Seven UK 1959



9 ft 8 in (2.9 m) long

⑦ Peel P50 UK 1963



4 ft 4 in (1.3 m) long

Car has a handle at the back for driver to pull it into parking spaces

Small is beautiful when you need a car to dodge and weave through narrow city streets, and to squeeze into the smallest parking spaces. Light in weight and easy on the pocket, their small engines make these mini motors cheap to run.

Partly inspired by the success of the Volkswagen Beetle, a wave of tiny cars hit the roads in the 1950s and 1960s. The compact Messerschmitt KR200 could accommodate only a driver and one passenger, while the egg-shaped BMW Isetta 300 had two front wheels placed close